Jimmy vs The Velvet Hammer

By Jon McGovern

JIMMY: (Pgs 15-22) Oh my head! *(Looks down at his clothing)* Oh, God, it's happened again. *(To the audience)* I've got a problem . . . don't laugh, 'cause it's not funny, it's causing me lots of mental stress. *(Adjusts himself and fixes his tie).* I've been . . . possessed! No, it's not what you think, it's not like I think UFO's came down and took over my body; and I didn't summon up the devil of anything . . . but I might as well have – Oh, I'll start from the beginning . . .

INTRODUCTION

It is never too late (or too early) to give yourself a new identity. If there are feats you wish to accomplish in life that seem to be too out of character for your current name, perhaps it's time to give yourself a boost with an alter ego. Clark Kent had Superman, Bruce Wayne had Batman, heck; even Miley Cyrus had Hanna Montana, so why shouldn't Jimmy have The Velvet Hammer?

Jimmy vs the Velvet Hammer from Alter Egos by Jon McGovern

JIMMY: See I'm pretty shy, I always have been . . . but . . . I really have always wanted to be a . . . STUD! You know, be tough, but tender, always says the right thing at the right time . . . like those guys from the seventies like Shaft and Superfly . . . But I never could be. I mean I get with a girl and my tongue would just stop – and I couldn't even form sentences. I just turn into Dork King of the Universe . . . "yer pretty" is usually the best I can do. That's the best of my "repertoire" . . .

Well, it had been a *(Make quote marks in the air)* "little while" since I was in a *(Make quote marks again)* "relationship." *(Sees audience might not be buying it)* OK! IT HAD BEEN A REALLY LONG TIME! And I was getting a bit *(Make quote mark)* "lonely," if you know what I mean . . . it got so bad there was a time when I just got – *you know* on the brain. I know you're thinking "who doesn't have *you know* on the brain sometimes." SOMETIMES is the key word there. It was like some tribal beating in my head –

FOR EDUCATIONAL USE ONLY

"*girlsGIRLSgirlsGIRLSgirlsGIRLSgirls* – a girl could say "excuse me" when passing me in the hall and I would start to have visions of her saying. . . oh boy. I couldn't do work – not even my favorite – calculus! I would just end up drawing dirty pictures and ordering *Cinemax*. I was turning into even more of a social misfit than before! It had to stop! Work was suffering, my professors were asking questions, my lab partners were getting annoyed, and my little dog Woofer was starting to look nervous. So, I used all my effort to just push it down – repress it – make it go to the back of my mind – I had a mantra –YOU MUST REPRESS YOU MUST REPRESS – I figured I would just get it off my mind, until I really met a girl who liked me and the time was right.

Oh, how wrong I was. The subconscious mind is a dangerous thing – tricky – because I thought my mantra worked. I was able to do work again – do my calculus, Woofer breathed a sigh of relief . . . But little strange things started to happen, even though they were deeply mixed into the rest of my normal life. I'd go to buy a pair of socks – sing a little tune – "Oh, I'm buyin' a pair a socks" – and instead I'd buy a pair of super-tight leather pants, a velvet turtleneck and a wide-brim hat with a feather, or I'd find myself casually browsing for sneakers – you know, Keds . . . Nikes . . . Dockers . . . but instead I'd get a pair of black, thigh-high, high-heeled boots! I mean, it all seemed normal at the time, like I needed those things . . . but after a while I had this strange collection of stuff. Like I was preparing for something – or someone. Then one night it all came together.

I was sleeping in bed and this voice said . . .

VELVET HAMMER: *(In a deep, gruff and soulful bass)* Git up!

JIMMY: I was shocked someone was in my apartment! So I said in my meanest voice . . . Who's there?

VELVET HAMMER: It's me, boy! Git up!

JIMMY: And then . . . my butt got slapped *(Slaps butt and continues to do so faster and faster)* – HARD – but no one was around . . . and then I realized *(Looks at his hand as the slapping stops)* it was me. I was slapping my own butt! "What's going on?" I said. There still wasn't a light on, so I yelled . . . Who are you? Where are you?

FOR EDUCATIONAL USE ONLY

VELVET HAMMER: I'm Velvet Hammer and I'm in you!

JIMMY: I didn't understand. So, I jumped out of bed and flipped on the light but no one was there! I was standing in front of my mirror . . . and instead of seeing me in my froggies-making-toast PJs, I was in these tight leather pants, velvet turtleneck and wide-brim hat with a feather, and then I said to myself . . . well, my lips moved and sound came out . . . but I didn't want to say it . . .

VELVET HAMMER: "See boy! We look good! Had to dress us up.

JIMMY: What do you mean, us? I'm ME.

VELVET HAMMER: Not anymore, baby. Yo' you and me . . . Velvet Hammer! You brought me here yo'self! You tried to push all yer sexy suff, all yer fun desire and tried to be Mr. Nice Boy. Well, all that stuff had to go somewhere . . . and, baby, I am from that place . . . I am the silky smooth, superfly, superfine guy from the deep heart of your personality. 'Cause tonight it's time to party! You have been Mr. Nice Boy too long and that means the Velvet Hammer been Mr. Nice Boy too long."

JIMMY: Look! I don't know what you are – you, evil spirit – but I won't let you possess me!

VELVET HAMMER: Possess you? I am you, the silky smooth, superfly fun part. And therefore, I just want us to have a little fun! Now look, you can either help out and be aware of what's goin' on and have the best night of your life, or I can just *(Goes into a '70s-style kung fu fight mode.)* Hutaa Hehtaa Huh huh Velvet Hamma! *(Back to normal)* Knock you out like I did when I was dressin' us! The choice is yours.

JIMMY: Oh . . . I was at this horrible turning point – let this weird evil spirit take over or try to fight? Get *(Does a Jimmy remix of Velvet's kung fu)* HooTa Hoo-Ha . . Ve-Vet Hammerrrr . . . knocked out? . . . or have the best night of my life? He was gonna do it anyway, so I said . . . OK

VELVET HAMMER: Good – now just relax, let it go – Velvet Hammer's in control!

JIMMY: Then it went black . . .

VELVET HAMMER: *(*theme from Shaft plays, hums, struts and does some mean dance moves – to a woman)* Hey, baby, my name's Velvet Hammer . . . 'cause I'm smooth like velvet . . . but I

FOR EDUCATIONAL USE ONLY

you know like a hammah!" *(Moves to another woman)* Hey, girl . . . I'm industrial strength – 'cause I work so hard– oohahhchaa!"

JIMMY: He was handing it out . . . getting phone numbers . . . getting phone numbers . . . Me! . . . as this Alter Ego was having the time of my life! But then I realized the more fun he was having, the more I felt like I was fading . . . then it hit me! If I didn't take back control of my body – the Velvet Hammer part of me would never give me up. I had to get back control! So, I waited till things calmed down a bit and – Velvet was doing his hair in the men's room – and then I tried to jump back in.

VELVET HAMMER: Woop! What are you tryin' to do, boy?

JIMMY: Look, Velvet, I'm taking my body back and there's nothing you can do about it!

VELVET HAMMER: Don't jive me, cat! I am just about to get to the piece of resistance of the night! The part that's gonna get us everything we want and more – I just about to strut on the dance floor!

JIMMY: Velvet, I have got control and I'm not going to give it up again.

VELVET HAMMER: That's what you think, boy! I'm gonna dance if it kills me!

JIMMY: Then I realized Velvet had control of one half of the body and I had control of the other!

VELVET HAMMER: Hit it, Mr. DJ! *(Dance music plays in the background as the battle for control over the body begins. Velvet's half trying to bump and grind, Jimmy's half trying to control it. As the dance continues we hear . . .)*

JIMMY: Velvet! Velvet, stop it stop stop . . . Oh! Don't do it, Velvet . . . Not the roboto, anything but that!" I didn't even know I could do the Running Man! *(He tries but only succeeds in making the dance more ridiculous . . .)* There was nothing I could do . . . I was fighting it hard, but it only ended up making me look like I was doing a funkier and funkier chicken! But . . . I was also starting to like it! I was the sexy star of the dance floor – everybody wanted me. So I just started to go with it . . and Go! And GO! And GOOOOO! *(Jimmy strikes a John Travolta pose and the music stops).* And then I blacked out . . . and I woke up, well, a lot like this -- I have these Velvet blackouts every weekend! Five days a

FOR EDUCATIONAL USE ONLY

week I'm nice mild-mannered bow-tie wearing, Discovery Channel watching me . . . and two days a week I'm this weird '70s guy – swingin' it all over town! I thought about trying to get an exorcist to get rid of him and stuff like that, but . . . if I do that, I'd also be getting rid of the one good side effect of all this . . . THE FLASHBACKS! *(Goes into a trance)*

VELVET HAMMER: Oh, you're a bad girl! Bad Girl! Oh, don't do that . . . *(Loving it)* . . . don't do that . . . *(Snaps out of the trance)*

JIMMY: WOW, WE SURE HAD FUN, DIDN'T WE, VELVET?"

VELVET HAMMER: We sho did.

JIMMY: But I'm tired, we gotta rest up for tonight.

VELVET HAMMER: Yeah! Why don't we go to get some Aunt Bertha take-out. . .

JIMMY: Oh OK. Well, I'll see you guys later. *(waves to the audience like the nerd he is)*

VELVET HAMMER: I'll see you later, baby girl. Come on, Jimmy, let's sang it. *(exit, strutting/stumbling singing the 70's tune of your choice, alternating between Velvet's and Jimmy's voice)*

SOURCE INFORMATION

Author: Jon McGovern
Book: Best Student One Acts: Vol. 4 (ed by Friesen, L)
From Alter Egos; Pgs 15-22
ISBN: 978-0871299123
Publisher: Dramatic Publishing
Date (Month/Year): August 2000

AWARD HISTORY

2001 National Qualifier
2013 National Qualifier
2016 National Qualifier
2017 National Qualifier
2023 National Qualifier
KS State Qualifier

****Theme from Shaft can be accessed at the following link***
https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Q429AOpL_ds

NOTE: Sexual references edited and noted with *_____*

FOR EDUCATIONAL USE ONLY